

We have a commitment to ensure exporters deliver acceptable animal welfare outcomes.

We investigate all alleged non-compliance with the [Exporter Supply Chain Assurance System \(ESCAS\)](#).

We take all allegations seriously.

Where necessary, the department acts immediately to address animal welfare issues.

Our process

Find out more about our [compliance investigation process](#).

Publishing reports

When we complete an investigation, we publish a report.

We publish information which may include the name of the holder of an export licence, occupier of a registered establishment or export business. This encourages compliance with [our regulatory framework](#), and provides assurance to Australia's trading partners regarding how we regulate livestock exports.

We will not release information if doing so could prejudice:

- the conduct of an investigation
- subsequent legal action in relation to an incident.

This includes information requested under the Freedom of Information Act 1982.

We do not release footage or images of these investigations. This type of content may fall outside accepted community standards. We have a responsibility to everyone who may access this information, including children. We want to ensure they do not see images they might find upsetting or disturbing.

Definition of terms

These are definitions of the terms we use to help you understand the status of an investigation. We use these terms to identify what step the report is at.

Term	Definition
Report under assessment	Under assessment to see if we need to complete an investigation
Assessment completed	We have assessed the information. We have determined a formal investigation is not required. A statement summarising the assessment is available.
Investigation in progress	The investigation is underway. It may take several months to:

Investigation complete We have finalised the investigation. A copy of the report and any administrative actions taken are available. If there is evidence of criminal offence, a separate investigation may be underway.

Recent and ongoing investigations

You can access ESCAS reports from 2019 here. To access reports completed before 2019 see the [National Library of Australia’s Trove archive](#).

NOTE: For the period of 1 January to 30 June 2026, no investigations were completed.
See:

NOTE: For the period of 1 October to 31 December 2025, no investigations were completed.
See:

Complaints and Investigations

Report No.	Type of Report or Complaint	Alleged Issue	Date reported to the Department	Status	Report
195	Complaint from Animals Australia	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for sheep exported to Jordan. Non-compliant handling and slaughter identified.	19 June 2025	Investigation Complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 July 2025 – 30 September 2025
194	Self-reported by exporters	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for sheep and goats exported to Malaysia. Goats were observed outside approved supply chains and non-compliant slaughter of a sheep was observed.	10 June 2025	Investigation Complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 July 2025 – 30 September 2025

NOTE: For the period of 1 January to 30 June 2025, no investigations were completed.
See:

NOTE: For the period of 1 January to 31 December 2024, no investigations were completed.

See:

**Complaints
and
Investigations**

Report No.	Type of Report or Complaint	Alleged Issue	Date reported to the Department	Status	Report
193	Complaint from Animals Australia	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for sheep exported to Jordan. Non-compliance relating to infrastructure, handling and slaughter identified.	5 September 2023	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 October 2023 – 31 December 2023
192	Independent Observer	Report of non-compliant handling of sheep during discharge in Jordan.	27 June 2023	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 July 2023 – 30 September 2023
191	Complaint from Animals Australia	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for sheep exported to Oman. Sheep were observed outside approved supply chains.	28 May 2023	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 July 2023 – 30 September 2023

NOTE: For the period 1 April to 30 June 2023, no investigations were completed.

See:

**Complaints
and
Investigations**

Report No.	Type of Report or Complaint	Alleged Issue	Date reported to the Department	Status	Report
190	Complaint from Animals Australia	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for sheep exported to the United Arab Emirates. Non-compliant handling and loading/unloading from transport vehicles identified.	18 July 2022	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 October 2022 – 31 December 2022

NOTE: For the period 1 July to 30 September 2022, no investigations were completed.

See:

Complaints and Investigations

Report No.	Type of Report or Complaint	Alleged Issue	Date reported to the Department	Status	Report
189	Complaint from Animals Australia	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for sheep exported to Jordan. Non-compliant handling and slaughter identified.	28 July 2021	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 July 2021 – 30 June 2022
188	Complaint from Animals Australia	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for cattle exported to Indonesia. Cattle were observed outside approved supply chains.	27 July 2021	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 July 2021 – 30 June 2022
187			26 July 2021		

	Complaint from Animals Australia	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for sheep exported to the United Arab Emirates. Sheep were observed outside approved supply chains.		Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 July 2021 – 30 June 2022
186	Complaint from PETA	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS animal welfare standards for cattle in Indonesia. Non-compliant handling and slaughter identified.	25 June 2021	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 January 2023 – 31 March 2023
185	Self reported by exporter	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for cattle exported to Vietnam. Cattle were moved to ESCAS approved facilities outside the exporter's supply chain.	2 February 2021	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 July 2021 – 30 June 2022

NOTE: For the period 1 January to 30 June 2021, no investigations were completed.

See:

Complaints and Investigations

Report No.	Type of Report or Complaint	Alleged Issue	Date reported to the Department	Status	Report
184	Self reported by exporter	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for cattle exported to Vietnam. Cattle were moved to	7 December 2020	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 July

		facilities outside the exporter's supply chain.			2021 – 30 June 2022
183	Self reported by exporter	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for cattle exported to Vietnam. Reported evidence of cattle flooding at one abattoir.	11 September 2020	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 July 2021 – 30 June 2022
182	Complaint from a third party	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for cattle exported to Vietnam. A third party reported cattle outside of approved supply chains and potential flooding of cattle.	25 August 2020	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 July 2021 – 30 June 2022
181	Complaint from Animals Australia	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for cattle exported to Israel and Gaza. Animals were observed outside approved supply chains.	11 August 2020	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 October – 31 December 2020
180	Complaint from Animals Australia	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS animal welfare standards for cattle in Indonesia. Non-compliant handling and slaughter identified.	7 August 2020	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 July 2021 – 30 June 2022
179	Self reported by exporter	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for sheep exported to Jordan. Animals were observed outside the approved supply chain. A subsequent report was received from Animals	28 July 2020	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 October – 31 December 2020

Australia on 31 July
2020 on the same issue.

178	Complaint from Animals Australia	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for sheep exported to Kuwait. Animals were observed outside approved supply chains.	23 July 2020	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 July – 30 September 2020
177	Independent Observer	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS control and animal welfare standards for sheep in Kuwait. During discharge of a consignment in Kuwait, sheep were removed from the loading platform and placed into a ute. The staff moving the sheep to the ute were observed pulling a sheep by its leg.	6 May 2020	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 July – 30 September 2020
176	Self reported by exporter	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS control standards for cattle in Vietnam. Cattle were moved to facilities outside the exporter's supply chain.	20 April 2020	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 July – 30 September 2020

NOTE: For the period 1 April to 30 June 2020, no investigations were completed.

See:

Complaints and Investigations

Report No.	Type of Report or Complaint	Alleged Issue	Date reported to the Department	Status	Report
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175	Self reported by exporter	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS animal welfare requirements for buffalo exported to Vietnam at an ESCAS approved abattoir.	31 December 2019	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 December 2019 – 31 March 2020
174	Self reported by exporter	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS control and traceability standards for cattle in Vietnam. Cattle were moved to facilities outside the exporter's supply chain and have lost traceability.	30 October 2019	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 September – 30 November 2019
173	Independent Observer	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS animal welfare standards during discharge of a consignment of cattle in the Philippines.	3 June 2019	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 June 2019 – 31 August 2019
172	Complaint from Animals Australia	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for cattle exported to Indonesia. Animals observed outside the approved supply chain, with non-compliant handling and slaughter identified.	13 August 2019	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 December 2019 – 31 March 2020
171	Complaint from Animals Australia	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for sheep exported to Malaysia. Animals were observed outside approved supply chains.	12 August 2019	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 June 2019 – 31 August 2019

170	Complaint from Animals Australia	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for sheep exported to Kuwait. Animals were observed outside approved supply chains.	5 August 2019	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 June 2019 – 31 August 2019
169	Complaint from Animals Australia	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for sheep exported to Kuwait. Animals were observed outside approved supply chains.	2 August 2019	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 December 2019 – 31 March 2020
168	Independent Observer	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS animal welfare standards during discharge of a consignment in Kuwait.	18 June 2019	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 June 2019 – 31 August 2019
167	Complaint from RSPCA Australia	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS requirements for cattle exported to Israel.	19 June 2019	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 June 2019 – 31 August 2019
166	Independent Observer	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS animal welfare standards during discharge of a consignment in Israel.	17 April 2019	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 June 2019 – 31 August 2019
165	Independent Observer	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS animal welfare standards during discharge of a consignment in Indonesia.	10 April 2019	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 March 2019 – 31 May 2019

164	Self reported by exporter	Report of non-compliance with ESCAS control, traceability and animal welfare requirements for cattle exported to Vietnam. Cattle were moved to facilities outside the exporter's supply chain and have lost traceability.	2 May/10 May 2019	Investigation complete	ESCAS Regulatory Performance Report 1 March 2019 – 31 May 2019
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Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/export/controlled-goods/live-animals/livestock/compliance-investigations/investigations-escas>